

August 28th, 2026
Week 35
Volume 282, Issue 1250



"The wind and the waves are always on the side of the ablest navigator."

- Edward Gibbon

Highlights:

- Sanctions land.

- Oil retreats.

- Freight rallies.

- Supply thins.

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-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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SANCTIONS LAND, SUPPLY THINS

The sanctions package hanging over last week's market has now landed. Washington broadened its economic campaign against Iran this week, extending the reach of secondary sanctions and placing shipping firmly within the latest measures. For a recycling market already navigating increasingly complex ownership structures, registries, trading histories and compliance exposure, the implications are clear. The pool of available candidates is already limited. The pool every destination can safely handle is smaller still.

Oil meanwhile surrendered much of the previous week's advance. Brent retreated back toward the high USD 80s per barrel, while WTI eased into the low USD 80s as improving Gulf flows removed some of the urgency from the supply story. The political impasse remains unresolved, but the barrel has once again distinguished disruption from outright shortage.

Freight moved firmly the other way. The Baltic Dry Index rallied above 3,100 to its strongest level since early June, with Capesizes leading the advance while Panamax and Supramax markets remained healthy. Tanker earnings also continue to benefit from Gulf disruption and altered trading patterns. For recycling, the conclusion remains familiar. Ageing ships are still earning enough money to stay at sea.

That freight strength remains the principal constraint on recycling supply. Fresh candidates continue to be remarkably sparse, despite healthy end-user appetite across the sub-continent. Buyers are available, yards have capacity and recent competition has shown how quickly numbers can move when suitable tonnage appears. What the market lacks is a steady flow of owners ready to sell.

Currencies were comparatively quiet. The Indian Rupee recovered some ground, the Pakistani Rupee strengthened again and the Bangladeshi Taka remained relatively steady against the Dollar. Turkey continued along its familiar path, with the Lira weakening into fresh record territory. With no major new inflation prints this week, oil, freight and the Dollar have again done most of the moving.

At the beaches, physical activity has improved more than the thin fresh-sales market would suggest. Chattogram turned over several units through the latest tide, Gadani finally started receiving some of the tonnage secured during its recent buying run, and Alang added another sizeable gas carrier to its pipeline. Much of this tonnage, however, was committed earlier. The beaches are consuming the existing pipeline faster than owners are replenishing it.

Bangladesh's wider market has also been overshadowed by the tragic accident earlier this month. Government authorities have suspended operations at the affected facility and opened formal investigations into the incident and the safety failures surrounding it, with further activity there halted pending the relevant findings and corrective measures.

August therefore closes with buyers willing, beaches active and fresh supply still stubbornly thin. Pakistan has cooled from its recent spike, Bangladesh is moving tonnage but needs fresh sales, and India continues to gather momentum through specialist and higher-value units. The beaches are moving. The supply line is not.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 35 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH



INVESTIGATION CONTINUES, TONNAGE MOVES

Investigation continues.

It has been a grim few weeks for the Bangladesh recycling market following the tragic accident earlier this month. Government authorities have suspended operations at the affected facility while investigations continue into exactly what occurred and the measures required to prevent any recurrence. The Ministry of Industries has constituted a formal investigation committee, while the environmental authorities have also taken enforcement action and barred a resumption of recycling activities at the facility pending the required clearances. The findings will understandably be watched closely across an industry that has invested heavily in improving safety and compliance standards.

Tonnage moves.

Commercially, the picture is quieter than the latest port movements might suggest. Fresh sales and buying activity remain sluggish, yet Chattogram has turned over a meaningful amount of previously secured tonnage through the latest tide. Than and Param were delivered on August 28, Bursa on August 27 and Wantong 498 on August 25, while the sizeable 27,824 LDT FPSO Glow arrived on August 27 and Orange Link remains another recent arrival. The beach is therefore working through its pipeline, even if fresh owners are not replenishing it at anything like the pace recyclers would like.

Fresh sales thin.

Local steel offered no fresh direction, holding at BDT 64,000 per ton, or approximately USD 522 per ton, throughout the week. The Taka has meanwhile strengthened from the upper end of its recent range, with Bangladesh Bank's spot reference rate closing August 27 near BDT 123.07 to the Dollar. The post-monsoon market has therefore yet to fully fire. Demand remains, capacity is available and vessels are moving through the yards, but the number of fresh candidates remains stubbornly thin. For now, the investigation continues to overshadow sentiment while the commercial market waits for its next meaningful wave of tonnage.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



SPECIALISTS LEAD, ALANG FIRMS

Alang's resurgence has continued into the final week of August, led once again by the specialist end of the market. Several higher-priced non-ferrous units, India-only green ships, reefers and a passenger candidate have given recyclers a useful stream of business at a time when standard dry and tanker tonnage remains difficult to secure against the substantially higher numbers available in Pakistan and Bangladesh.

Plate firms.

The latest port position adds further weight to that improving picture, with the 18,848 LDT LPG carrier Ble In arriving at Alang on August 23. It follows a productive run of specialist deliveries through recent weeks and reinforces India's ability to attract tonnage that does not necessarily trade according to the conventional sub-continent price board. Local steel has also moved firmly in the right direction. Alang plate started the period at INR 40,500 per ton, strengthened through INR 41,000 and briefly touched INR 41,300, before closing Friday back at INR 41,000, equivalent to approximately USD 429 per ton against USD 423 at the start of the period. The Rupee has been similarly supportive, recovering from last week's 95.77 area to around 95.55 against the Dollar by Friday.

Specialists lead.

India still has some distance to travel before threatening the far higher conventional levels available from its sub-continent competitors, but the signs heading toward the fourth quarter are considerably more encouraging. Alang's compliance infrastructure, deep yard capacity and ability to handle complex, green and higher-value units continue to give it opportunities even when straightforward pricing does not. The market remains third on standard tonnage. The gap is narrowing, and the specialist lane is keeping Alang busy while it does.

Alang improves.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN



PRICES COOL, HULLS ARRIVE

Hulls arrive.

Gadani remains the story of the sub-continent market after an extraordinary run through August. Fierce competition for an exceptionally limited pool of candidates pushed tanker values to some of the strongest levels seen in Pakistan for several years, with a number of units reportedly committed above USD 550 to USD 560/LDT. That burst of buying finally satisfied part of the pent-up requirement that had been building among recyclers.

The inevitable correction has now followed. Local steel fell from PKR 203,000 per ton, or approximately USD 730 per ton, to PKR 200,000, near USD 720 per ton, from August 25 onward. Vessel pricing has cooled in tandem as the most urgent local requirements have been covered, but this should not be mistaken for disappearing appetite. The shortage of workable candidates remains acute and Gadani recyclers are still prepared to compete for the right unit.

Prices correct.

More importantly, some of the tonnage secured during the recent buying run has finally reached the waterfront. The 8,128 LDT container vessel Visakha and the 4,990 LDT tanker Lyra both arrived at Gadani on August 21. Last week's unusual situation, where Pakistan had risen to the top of the market with almost nothing on the beach, is therefore beginning to resolve.

The Rupee remains another firm pillar beneath the market. The State Bank's August 28 revaluation rate stood at approximately PKR 277.50 to the Dollar, continuing the remarkable stability and gradual strengthening that has accompanied Gadani's recent revival. Pakistan's official reserves also edged higher in the latest weekly data.

Gadani holds.

At the same time, yards continue their efforts to move further toward Hong Kong Convention standards ahead of what is expected to be a busier period of recycling supply in the years to come. Recent weeks have demonstrated that Pakistan can once again compete at the very top of the market when sufficient demand and suitable tonnage align.

The spike has cooled. The hulls have arrived. The appetite remains.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

THROUGH 48, NICHE HOLDS



The Lira continued its orderly slide this week, with USD/TRY moving into the 48.1 to 48.2 range and fresh record territory as the managed depreciation that has defined much of the year continued. July's official inflation reading remains 31.75% annually and 1.78% monthly, while August consumer confidence improved modestly to 90.8.

Lira slides.

For Aliaga recyclers, little has changed commercially. The weaker Lira continues to constrain Dollar-denominated buying power and Turkey remains structurally removed from the aggressive numbers available across the sub-continent. Its market continues to be defined by EU regulation, Basel Convention compliance and specialist tonnage rather than any effort to challenge South Asian destinations on conventional price.

Market steady.

Aliaga therefore enters September much as it entered August. The currency keeps moving, the price board barely does, and the continuing improvement of compliant recycling capacity farther east remains the structural development worth watching.

Niche holds.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 35 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	Steady	520 / LDT	540 / LDT	550 / LDT
2	Bangladesh	Steady	500 / LDT	520 / LDT	530 / LDT
3	India	Steady	465 / LDT	485 / LDT	495 / LDT
4	Turkey	Steady	262-264 / LDT	272-274 / LDT	282-284 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *44.4 billion kWh of energy saved through ship recycling at Alang could power more than 3 million households for 10 years.*
- *Ship recycling at Alang is estimated to have saved enough landfill space to accommodate more than 276 million cubic yards of material.*
- *CO₂ emissions avoided through ship recycling at Alang are equivalent to the emissions generated by approximately 180 billion kilometres of passenger-car travel.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
September 04 – Janmashtami October 02 - Mahatma Gandhi's Birthday	August 26 – September 03 September 08 - September 16

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
September 04 – Janmashtami	August 28 – August 31 September 10 – September 13

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	August 30 – Victory Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of August 28, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Ble In	18,848	LPG Carrier	Arrived August 23

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of August 28, 2026

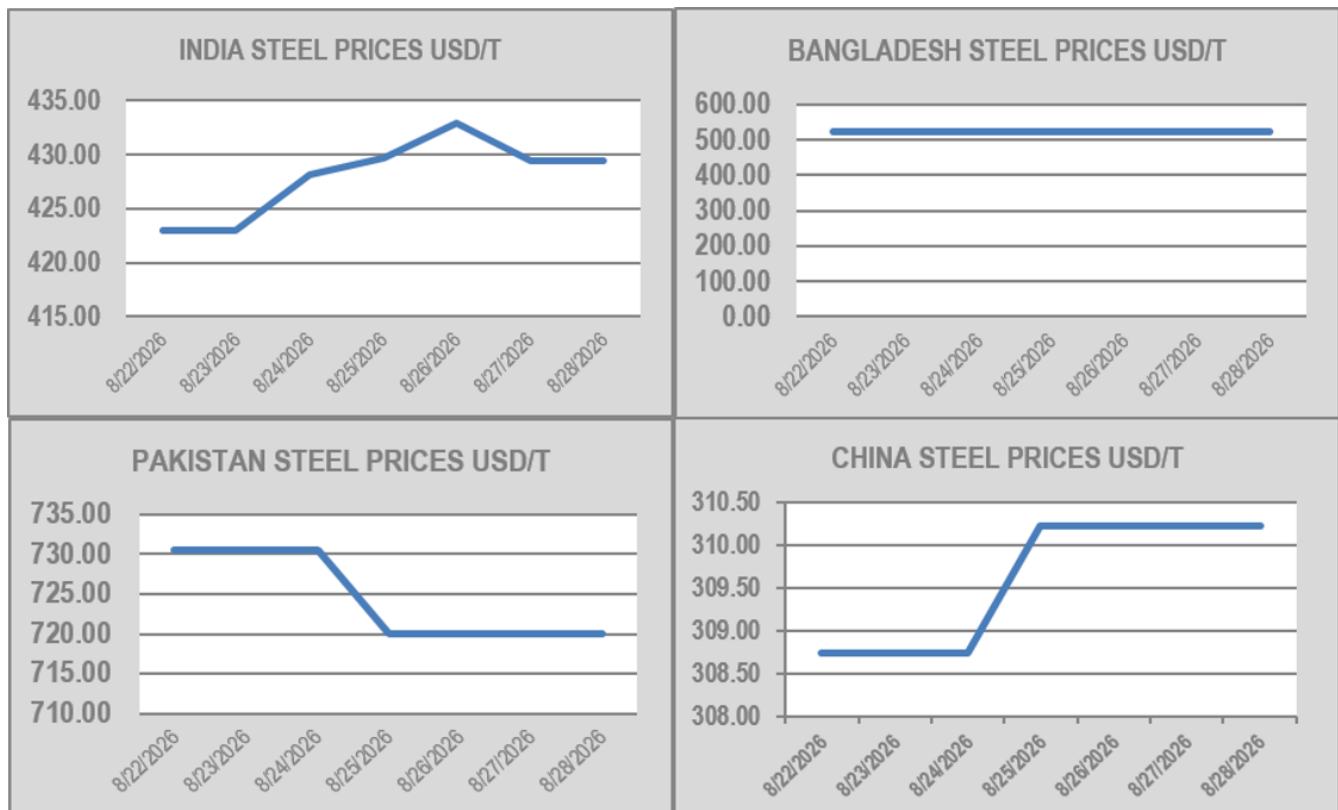
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Than	6,357	Wood Chip Carrier	<i>Delivered August 28</i>
2	Param	9,520	Bulk Carrier	<i>Delivered August 28</i>
3	Glow (D/VSL)	27,824	FPSO	Arrived August 27
4	Bursa	15,965	Tanker	<i>Delivered August 27</i>
5	Wantong 498	1,589	Waste Disposal Vessel	<i>Delivered August 25</i>
6	Orange Link	3,846	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 22

GADANI - Port Position as of August 28, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Visakha	8,128	Container	Arrived August 21
2	Lyra	4,990	Tanker	Arrived August 21

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
8/22/2026	422.98	40,500.00	730.48	203,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	308.75
8/23/2026	422.98	40,500.00	730.48	203,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	308.75
8/24/2026	428.20	41,000.00	730.48	203,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	308.75
8/25/2026	429.72	41,000.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	310.23
8/26/2026	432.87	41,300.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	310.23
8/27/2026	429.45	41,000.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	310.23
8/28/2026	429.45	41,000.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	310.23



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